UNIT-III

Understand: How to make Formal Presentations. *Practice:* Formal Presentations

4.3. MAKING A PRESENTAION

OBJECTIVE:

To be able to prepare presentations and present them in front of an audience.

SKILLS DEVELOPED:

a. How to plan a presentation.
b. How to present it to an audience.
c. How to respond to questions.

RUBRIC FOR ASSESSMENT:

a. Relevance and complexity of topic(appropriate to level of students).
b. Content of presentation.
c. Manner of presentation, body language, intonation.
d. Handling of audience responses.

Time limit: 25 minutes per presentation.

Planning: 10 minutes.

Preparation of slides/charts: 10 minutes.

Presentation: 5 minutes.

Mode: Group work.

Presentations can be made in different ways:

- Computer projection (using application such as Excel, PowerPoint, etc.)
- Flipcharts, blackboards or whiteboards, sometimes used as 'scratchpads' to expand on a point.
- Video or film.
- Real objects (such as a product or plan specimen).

PREPARING A PRESENTATION:

- Decide the subject of the presentation. If it has not been assigned to you , choose a topic that suits the occasion and the audience.
- Think about the objective or purpose: is it meant to inform, persuade or report?
- Think of who your audience is going to be; the level of your content, formality and style will depend on this.
- Next, list the main points you want to make in your presentation. It is important not to pack too much content into a presentation because this will diffuse its effect. For example, a presentation of about twenty minutes should not have more than five main points. After you have a final list of points, arrange them in a logical sequence.
- Think of sub-points that could come under your main points. It is best to put only the main points and the sub-points on slide (or flip chart) and speak briefly on each of these.
- Do not put in too much text into the slide. This makes the slide crowded and also difficult to read.
- Prepare graphs, tables or pie charts that you want to show on the slides.
- Ensure that the presentation has a clear conclusion.
- Plan your presentation in a way that will enable you to the time allotted to you.
- Finally, prepare your presentation early and rehearse it as many times as you can.

STRUCTURING CONTENT:

- The first part must consist of greetings, a brief, clear statement of the subject and purpose of the presentation and an outline.
- The second part must have the main content of the presentation.
- The last part must have a brief recap or a summary of the most important points.

VISUAL AIDS:

- All the visuals you show must be related to your talk.
- Make sure the slides, charts or transparencies are in the right order, matching the sequence of point in your presentation.
- Do not put in too much information on one visual.
- Written matter on slides and transparencies should be in the form of key words or phrases, points or short sentences.
- Prepare your slides in such a way that the audience sees only one visual or point at a time.
- It is useful to give the audience handouts at the end of your presentation.
- Visuals should be simple, clear and appealing.
- Use a minimum 20-point Times Roman or any other friendly typeface that can be read from a distance.

DELIVERING THE PRESENTATION:

- Stick to your original plan for the presentation. Do not take up other matters, however interesting they may be , because this will lead to confusion.
- Modulate your voice according to the size of the room and the audience.
- Before you show a slide or a transparency, tell the audience something about it. After it is put on screen, explain it more fully.
- Do not read out the matter on the screen or a prepared script.
- Do not block the screen or stand facing it so that your back is turned to the audience.
- Remember that your appearance, posture, facial expressions, eye contact with the audience and body language are important non-verbal signal.

OPENING REMARKS:

- ✓ Hello, everyone. (appropriate for an informal presentation for a small group of people you interact with every day)
- ✓ Good morning/Good afternoon/Good evening. Welcome to…(name of organization)/Thank you for giving me the opportunity to talk to you today.
- ✓ Good morning. I'd like to/I'm happy to welcome you all here today.

STATING THE PURPOSE:

- ✓ As you know, the subject of my presentation today is…
- ✓ I'm here this morning to…
- ✓ My aim is to…

GIVING AN OUTLINE:

- ✓ I've divided my presentation into…
- ✓ I'll first…, then we'll… Finally, I'll…
- ✓ I'll begin by… and after that I'll deal with… before going on to… The presentation will conclude with…

GIVING OTHER PRELIMINARY INFORMATION AND STARTING WITH THE CONTENT:

- ✓ My presentation will take about half an hour or so. If you don't mind, could I deal with questions after the talk, please.
- ✓ I'll take only about fifteen minutes of your time. We'll have a question-and-answer session after that.
- ✓ The presentation is going to take around forty minutes. Please feel free to interrupt if you have a question.

- ✓ You don't need to/needn't take notes. I'll give a set of handouts with all the points we discuss today.

MOVING TO ANSWER POINT OR GOING BACK TO AN EARLIER POINT:

- ✓ Let's now turn to…
- ✓ This takes me to my next point about…
- ✓ Let me go back briefly to an earlier point.

EMPHASISING IMPORTANT POINTS:

- ✓ What we must understand/realize/do is…
- ✓ What we mustn't do is…
- ✓ We urgently/really need to…

DRAWING ATTENTION TO VISUALS:

- ✓ I'd like to draw your attention to…
- ✓ Could you just look at the… on the screen.
- ✓ As you'll see in the next slide.

MAKING RECOMMENDATIONS:

- ✓ I (strongly) recommend that…
- ✓ My recommendation is that…
- ✓ I really think/believe we should…

KEEPING THE AUDIENCE INVOLVED:

- ✓ How would you solve this problem?
- ✓ Where are we heading?
- ✓ Can you think of a way of dealing with this?
- ✓ What are the options open to us?
- ✓ Why should we be concerned about this?

SUMMARISING AND CONCLUDING:

- ✓ To sum up the main points of my presentation,…
- ✓ Before I end my talk, I'd like to summaries its main points.
- ✓ To run through/recap my main points,…

INVITING QUESTIONS:

- ✓ If you have any questions, please feel free to ask them.
- ✓ If want to ask any questions, I'll do my best to answer them.
- ✓ If there are any questions, I'll be pleased to answer them.